

Lesson 11: Final Project

Intro to Programming — Code the Dream

Session Overview

Today's session is about you and your project.

- Reflect on everything you've learned over the past 11 weeks
- Review the final project requirements and submission checklist
- Spend the bulk of the session working on your project with mentor support

There is no new content today — this time belongs to you.

Explore

The Arc of the Course

Three big phases:

1. **The language** — Learning to speak JavaScript (variables, loops, functions, objects)
2. **The browser** — Making things appear and respond (HTML, CSS, DOM, events)
3. **The internet** — Connecting to the outside world (Fetch, APIs, async)

Your final project uses all three.

Check for Understanding

Which of these concepts did you use in your portfolio project?

(Select all that apply — unmute or drop them in the chat)

- A) Writing and calling functions
- B) Looping through an array to display items
- C) Handling a form submit event
- D) Using `fetch()` to get data from an API
- E) Selecting and creating DOM elements

Concepts That Stick

A few things worth remembering long after this course:

- **Functions** — every program is built from reusable pieces
- **Arrays + loops** — the pattern for displaying any list of data
- **Events** — how the browser listens and responds to users
- **Fetch + async/await** — how modern apps talk to servers
- **Git and GitHub** — how developers share and protect their work

These aren't just Intro to JavaScript concepts — they are the foundations of every web application you'll ever build.

Check for Understanding

Looking back at the course, which topic felt like the biggest breakthrough moment for you?

(Drop it in the chat — no wrong answers)

- A) Getting a function to return the right value
- B) Making something appear or change on the page
- C) Handling user input from a form
- D) Seeing real data load from an API
- E) Something else entirely

Apply

Final Project: Two Parts

Part 1 — Portfolio Page (`index.html`)

- About, Experience, Skills, Projects, and Leave a Message sections
- Dynamic footer with copyright year
- Skills rendered from a JavaScript array
- Message form: submit, display, and remove messages
- GitHub repositories fetched and displayed from the API

Part 2 — Open API Page (`openapi.html`)

- Two separate GET requests to two different endpoints
- Navigation between the two data views
- Error handling for failed requests
- Linked from your portfolio — and links back

Portfolio Rubric — Key Requirements Part 1

HTML

- Valid boilerplate, semantic structure, internal navigation links, all five sections present

JavaScript

- Footer copyright year generated dynamically
- Skills list rendered from an array using a loop
- Message form: validates input, displays messages, includes remove buttons
- GitHub repos fetched via the API and displayed on the page

Portfolio Rubric - Key Requirements Part 2

CSS

- Flexbox used for layout
- Clean, readable styling throughout

Full rubric: linked in your lesson materials on Canvas/Slack

Open API Rubric — Key Requirements

Structure

- Separate HTML, CSS, and JavaScript files
- Linked from portfolio nav, with a link back to the portfolio

JavaScript

- Two distinct GET requests to two different API endpoints
- Clear navigation so users can switch between the two data views
- Error handling (e.g., a message shown if the fetch fails)

Presentation

- Data displayed in a readable, styled format
- Code is clean and organized

Submission Checklist

Before you submit, confirm all of this:

- ☐ All open pull requests are merged into `main`
- ☐ Portfolio page meets the Portfolio Rubric
- ☐ Open API page meets the Open API Rubric
- ☐ Code runs without errors in the browser
- ☐ Final project **repository URL** submitted on Canvas
- ☐ Project **demo video** recorded (3–5 min) and uploaded as Unlisted on YouTube
- ☐ Demo video link submitted on Canvas

When in doubt, open the rubric and go line by line.

Demo Video — What to Cover

Your 3–5 minute video should walk through:

1. Scroll through your **portfolio** to show layout and styling
2. Demo the **message form** — submit a message, show it on the page, remove it
3. Switch to your **Open API page**
4. Show **both endpoints** loading data with navigation between them
5. Share **what challenged you most** and **what you enjoyed most**

You can record with Zoom, your computer's screen recorder, or Loom.

Tips for Finishing Strong

1. **Work from the rubric** — check off each item as you confirm it works
2. **Functionality before polish** — get everything working before tweaking styles
3. **Test in the browser often** — save, refresh, check the console after every change
4. **Use DevTools** — Console tab for JavaScript errors, Elements tab for layout issues
5. **Merge early** — don't wait until the last minute to merge your PRs
6. **Ask for help** — your mentors are here right now, and Slack is always open

The finish line is closer than it feels.

Work Session

The next 25–30 minutes are yours.

Here's how to make the most of it:

- **Unmute or use the chat** to ask questions anytime
- **Share your screen** if you want debugging help — mentors will jump in
- **Use breakout rooms** if you'd like one-on-one support

If you're already in good shape: help a classmate, or review your demo video script.

Wrap-Up

Zoom chat:

What's one thing you know now that you didn't know 11 weeks ago?

Take a moment and type it out — we want to read them.

What's Next

You've completed **Intro to Programming!**

Once your final project is reviewed and you've passed the course assessment:

- You will officially **graduate** from this course
- You'll be ready to advance to your **next course** in the CTD curriculum
- Keep building, keep asking questions, and stay connected on **Slack**

The CTD community — your classmates, mentors, and staff — is always here.

Resources

Resource	What it's for
Portfolio Rubric	Full checklist for your portfolio page
Open API Rubric	Full checklist for your Open API page
MDN Web Docs	Reference for HTML, CSS, and JavaScript
GitHub Docs	Help with pull requests and merging
Slack <code>#discussion</code>	Questions anytime, even after the course

Rubric links are in your Lesson 11 materials on Canvas.

Congratulations!

You are a programmer!

Thank you for an incredible course. We cannot wait to see what you build next.